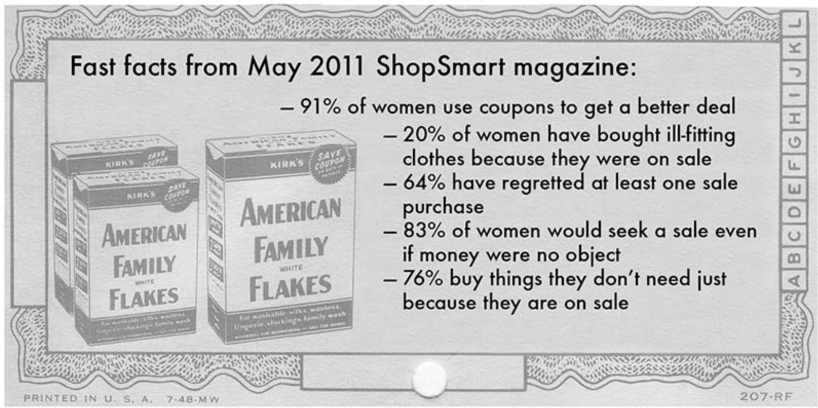
savings at least equal to the time cost of their coupon clipping. She then expanded the basic cost-benefit model of coupon use to see if the enjoyment of clipping them was significantly greater for those consumers who were inefficiently using them, but didn't find that to be the case.



Maybe it isn't the clipping, the comparing prices, or even the savings itself that gives extreme couponers the "high" they get with their super shopping trips. Perhaps it has more to do with the customer being solely responsible for obtaining the discount, a sort of "smart-shopper" syndrome.

Robert M. Shindler looked at just this possibility in two studies that were published in the *Journal of Consumer Psychology* in 1998. In looking at "coupon queens," for example, he suggested that the anecdotal evidence of price promotions was capable of generating enthusiasm beyond the economic value of the money saved. He measured a consumer's perception of themselves as general "smart shoppers" in regards to their level of involvement in obtaining the discounts. Two possible sources of pride-like feelings in relation to a discount were apparent.

First, there was the *added-weight* explanation: the pride of obtaining a discount might increase the value of the discount by adding weight or